

**Brecksville Broadview Heights City School District
Board of Education
Brecksville, Ohio**

The Board of Education of the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District, County of Cuyahoga, Ohio, met in a regular board meeting at 7:00 p.m. on the 22nd day of January, 2020 at the Education Center, 6638 Mill Road, Brecksville, Ohio 44141, with the following members present:

Members Present: Mr. Mark Dosen
Mrs. Ellen Kramer
Mrs. Kathleen Mack
Mr. Fred Pedersen
Mrs. Brittany Wigman

Resolution Number: 2020-17

RESOLUTION OPPOSING THE STATE OF OHIO EdCHOICE SCHOLARSHIP (VOUCHER) PROGRAM

WHEREAS, the Ohio legislature has recently made amendments which greatly increase the number and availability of vouchers for students to attend private/parochial schools at public tax expense, and

WHEREAS, such vouchers will be available to numerous families who have never attended Brecksville-Broadview Heights or any other public schools, and

WHEREAS, Brecksville-Broadview Heights state funding will be unjustly decreased by the amount of the vouchers provided to such families and students who have not and will not attend public schools and others who transfer to private/ parochial schools, and

WHEREAS, private/parochial schools accepting students with public tax vouchers would not be required to accept all students but would be permitted to retain their selective admission policies without enforcement of other laws applicable to public schools, and

WHEREAS, private/ parochial school students are not subject to the testing standards required of public school students so that the actual performance of private/parochial schools subsidized with public tax dollars will not be known, relative to equivalent public school evaluation standards, and

WHEREAS, this Board believes that the EdChoice voucher program as it currently exists presents serious constitutional issues regarding the separation of church and state and the funding of religious institutions with public tax dollars, and

WHEREAS, the State of Ohio has the constitutional responsibility to secure a thorough and efficient system of common schools, and

WHEREAS, the EdChoice voucher program will have exactly the opposite effect by providing funding to private/ parochial schools at the expense and to the detriment of public schools and their students.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by this Brecksville-Broadview Heights City Schools District Board of Education that this Board reaffirms its commitment to free accessible public schools which are adequately and equitably funded to guarantee a comparable education for ALL children and therefore opposes and respectfully requests the repeal of the ill-conceived EdChoice voucher program of the State of Ohio.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Board opposes any funding programs, vouchers or otherwise, that have the effect of diverting public tax dollars from public schools to private/parochial schools.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Treasurer is hereby authorized and directed to forward copies of this Resolution to all Ohio state legislators, the Superintendent of Public Instruction and Governor of the State of Ohio.

Ayes: _____

Nays: _____

Treasurer's Certificate

The above is a true and correct extract from the minutes of a regular meeting of the Board of Education of the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District, Ohio, held on January 22, 2020, commencing at _____ p.m. at the Education Center, 6638 Mil Road, Brecksville, showing the adoption of the resolution hereinabove set forth.

Dated: 01/22/2020

John W. Scott, Interim Treasurer
Brecksville-Broadview Heights City Schools